

“We need flexibility and scalability, and we get that with Linux”



Parting ways from proprietary technologies is not all that difficult. The transition becomes easy if one is determined. In the case of BookMyShow, what mattered was the intention to get the best technologies on board. **Viraj Patel, VP, technology, Bigtree Entertainment Pvt Ltd**, did just that. In a tête-à-tête with **Diksha P. Gupta** from **Open Source For You**, Patel shares his journey into the world of open source technology and how he guided the company through its open source journey, pretty successfully. Excerpts...

Q Could you tell us for what purposes you have deployed open source technology in your company and how this impacts day to day operations?

A major part of our business comprises BookMyShow, which as a platform has made considerable use of open source technology. Originally, when BookMyShow was launched in 2007, it was completely on the Microsoft stack. Only in 2009 did we move our website to the LAMP stack. Today, our website runs entirely on PHP and there are a lot of backend applications that were created later, which also run on open source technologies, like Node.JS, MongoDB, etc. We still have some operations running on Microsoft but that is reducing, day by day. Today, we have less than 10 per cent of our servers running on Windows, whereas more than 90 per cent are running on CentOS.

Q So how has the open source adoption journey been so far?

We began that journey in 2009. Basically, BookMyShow is built on the micro-services model. For almost everything we do, we have a service. For instance, to send an SMS, we